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AGENTIC THREAT HUNTING

MATERIALS GUIDE · DEATHCON 2026

github.com/Nebulock-Inc/agentic-hunting-workshop-deathcon-2026

The most up-to-date information will be here.

HOW THIS WORKSHOP RUNS

A **60-minute video** and a **~90-minute self-paced lab**. Watch a module, hit the pause slide, do the lab, come back for the debrief.

#	MODULE	VIDEO	LAB	YOU'LL WRITE
1	**Manual + structure**	11 min	25 min	H-0004, H-0005
2	**Search + similarity**	9 min	20 min	H-0006
3	**Research agents**	8 min	15 min	H-0007
4	**Agentic MCP**	9 min	15 min	H-0008
5	**The pivot** — no hand-holding	6 min	15 min	H-0009

Setup (pause point 0) happens **before** Module 1 and isn't counted in the 90 minutes.

WHAT YOU GET

MATERIAL	WHAT IT IS
The video	The 60-minute walkthrough. Pause at every ⏸ slide.
The deck	Every slide, as PDF and HTML.
Lab Workbook (PDF)	Every lab's guiding questions and queries. No answers.
The repo	`commands/`, `templates/`, `queries/`, `providers/`, `preflight/`, `PRE_READ.md`
Splunk	Your own read-only login to the seeded environment, with the workshop app.
ATHF	The open-source framework you hunt with. `pip install`, MIT-licensed.

Everything lives at **github.com/Nebulock-Inc/agentic-hunting-workshop-deathcon-2026**.

BEFORE YOU START

- **Python 3.8+** (3.11+ recommended).
- **One LLM API key.** OpenAI or Anthropic is the supported path. Bedrock, Ollama, and OpenAI-compatible endpoints also work.
- **An MCP client** for Modules 4–5. Claude Code is the default; Cursor and Copilot work too.
- **A text editor and a browser.**
- **Basic SPL.** You should be able to read and write a simple search. No AI or agent experience needed; that's what this is for.
- **New to hunting?** Read `PRE_READ.md` first. It takes 10 minutes.

SETUP — PAUSE POINT 0

```
python3 -m venv .venv && source .venv/bin/activate     # Windows: .venv\Scripts\activate
pip install 'agentic-threat-hunting-framework[all]'
cp providers/<your-provider>.env.example .env          # paste your API key
python preflight/validate.py                           # all green = ready
```

- `[all]` matters: it includes the similarity and MCP extras. Without it, Module 2 fails on a scikit-learn error.
- Put your key in `.env` **or** your shell, never both.
- **Wire up MCP now**, not in Module 4. Follow `providers/mcp.md`: point your client at `athf-mcp`, set `ATHF_WORKSPACE` to your workspace, then ask *"What have I hunted before?"*

SPLUNK

- **Login:** the URL and credentials DEATHcon gave you. Read-only.
- **Index:** everything is in `index=thrunt`.
- **Time range: All time. Every search. Every time.** The data is fixed at **Oct 23 – Oct 30, 2026** and doesn't move with the calendar. "Last 24 hours" returns nothing and looks like Splunk is broken.
- **Need a bounded window?** Use absolute dates: `earliest="10/23/2026:00:00:00"` `latest="10/31/2026:00:00:00"`.

THE WORKSHOP APP IN SPLUNK

Open the **Agentic Threat Hunting Workshop** app. Its menu has four pages:

PAGE	USE IT FOR
Orientation Workbook	Start here. If the panels show numbers, you can see the data.
Lab Runner	Each lab in Splunk, with the queries as copy-ready text.
Search	Run your queries without leaving the app.
Answer Key	It's there on purpose. Ask your repo first, then check.

THE FIVE LEVELS OF AGENTIC HUNTING

LEVEL	NAME	WHAT IT MEANS
L0	Ad-hoc	Hunt in a search bar. Close the laptop, the hunt is gone.
L1	Documented	Write the hunt down so it survives you.
L2	Searchable	Find the next hunt by reusing the last one.
L3	Generative	An agent reads intel and hands you hypotheses.
L4	Agentic	An agent with tools finds what you haven't covered.

THE MEMORY IS THE MOAT.

LOCK — THE SHAPE OF A HUNT

- **L — Learn:** what triggered this hunt? Intel, an anomaly, a gap.
- **O — Observe:** the hypothesis and the query. What behavior would this actor leave?
- **C — Check:** run it, triage it, rule things out. Dead ends count.
- **K — Keep:** the finding, the SPL, the verdict. `athf similar` reads this later.

> A ruled-out hypothesis is still a finding.

THE COMMANDS

COMMAND	WHEN
`athf init`	Once, Module 1. Press Enter through the prompts.
`athf hunt new …`	Every hunt. Or copy a template.
`athf hunt list` · `athf hunt validate`	End of every lab
`athf similar` · `athf hunt coverage`	Module 2 onward
`athf research new`	Module 3
MCP: *"What should I hunt next?"*	Module 4 onward

All of it is in `commands/`. Run the file; don't retype it.

Hate typing flags? Copy `templates/H-000X.md` into `hunts/` and fill in Check and Keep in your editor. `athf hunt validate` and `athf similar` treat it the same either way.

WHERE THINGS LIVE

IN THE REPO	WHAT'S IN IT
`commands/`	Every ATHF command from the labs, ready to run.
`templates/`	Hunt files for H-0004 … H-0009, ready to fill in.
`queries/m1.md` … `m5.md`	Every SPL query from each lab, in order. Copy from here, not the PDF.
`providers/`	One `.env.example` per LLM provider, plus `mcp.md` for MCP setup.
`preflight/validate.py`	The setup checker. All green means you're ready.
`PRE_READ.md`	The 10-minute primer: hunting vs. detection, the levels, LOCK, ABLE.

Your hunts land in **your** workspace under `hunts/`. That folder is the memory everything in Modules 2–5 builds on.

STUCK?

SYMPTOM	FIX
A search returns nothing	Time range → **All time**. Then check you typed `index=thrunt`.
Preflight shows red	Read the line it prints; it names the fix.
`similar` errors on scikit-learn	Reinstall with `[all]`.
MCP client can't connect	`which athf-mcp` must resolve inside the venv your client launches from.
Agent says no hunts found	`ATHF_WORKSPACE` must be the folder with `hunts/` in it.

Still stuck? Ask in the workshop Discord channel. Bring your H-0009 and whatever stumped you.

AFTER THE WORKSHOP

- The Splunk environment stays up for **months** after DEATHcon. Pick up where you left off, still on **All time**.
- Your ATHF workspace is **yours**. Keep hunting in it on Monday.
- Everything is open source and MIT-licensed: the framework, the labs, the templates.
- **The survey takes 90 seconds**, and it shapes the next version.

STAY CURIOUS. HUNT WEIRD.